準2級+

第8回

英検準2級プラス形式

# リーディング練習

第8回　｜　部分演習（筆記全体の制限時間は流用しません）　｜　選択問題 31問

## ■ 出題構成・自己採点記録表

| 大問 | 問題番号 | 出題形式・内容 | 設問数 | 自己採点・点検 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1** | (1)〜(17) | 短文の語句空所補充 | 17問 | ／17 |
| **2** | (18)〜(23) | 長文の語句空所補充 | 6問 | ／6 |
| **3** | (24)〜(31) | 長文の内容一致選択 | 8問 | ／8 |

## ■ 演習・印刷の手引き

1. 問題冊子には正答や解説を載せていません。解答用紙はA4横マークシート（1ページ）です。
2. 印刷時は「白黒・実際のサイズ（100%）」を選ぶと、マーク欄や英作文罫線が本番見本に近い実寸で出力されます。
3. 解き終わるまでは「解答・解説」を開かず、本番と同じ時間配分を意識して取り組んでください。
4. 同じ選択問題はアプリの「分野別練習」、英作文課題はアプリの「ライティング練習」でも学習・保存できます。

実施日：　　年　　月　　日　　開始〜終了：　　：　　〜　　：

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿　　選択問題 合計：　　／31 点

※ 本冊子はマナトビが独自に執筆・編集した英検準2級プラス形式のオリジナル教材（第8回）です。リスニング・二次面接は含みません。日本英語検定協会の公式過去問・公式予想問題ではなく、CSEスコア算出や合否判定は行いません。外部機関による難度校正は未実施です。

## 1

次の(1)から(17)までの（ ）に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選び、その番号のマーク欄をぬりつぶしなさい。

***(1)*** To (　　) waste at the campus festival, food stalls offered a fifty-yen discount to visitors who brought reusable bowls.

**1** crawl　**2** carve　**3** curb　**4** crush

***(2)*** The mountain hut has solar panels that generate (　　) electricity to run lights and a radio, though not hair dryers.

**1** sufficient　**2** superficial　**3** subsequent　**4** suspicious

***(3)*** Although the new software looked unfamiliar at first, our office staff soon got the (　　) of it.

**1** head　**2** hold　**3** hand　**4** hang

***(4)*** Heavy snowfall brought highway traffic to a complete (　　) for nearly three hours.

**1** viewpoint　**2** standstill　**3** landmark　**4** breakthrough

***(5)*** Students may borrow the 3D printer free of charge, (　　) that they complete a thirty-minute safety orientation first.

**1** whereas　**2** unless　**3** provided　**4** despite

***(6)*** The documentary was praised for presenting an (　　) account of the harbor project, interviewing supporters and critics alike.

**1** impatient　**2** impulsive　**3** immature　**4** impartial

## 1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

***(7)*** Exposure to direct afternoon sunlight can cause rare watercolor pigments to (　　) over time.

**1** fade　**2** fold　**3** float　**4** flee

***(8)*** Our town's Disaster Preparedness Guide was translated into five languages to ensure broad (　　) among foreign residents.

**1** awkwardness　**2** awareness　**3** ambition　**4** abundance

***(9)*** The wooden bridge was inspected thoroughly and found to be (　　) sound despite fifty winters of heavy snow.

**1** structurally　**2** reluctantly　**3** mutually　**4** casually

***(10)*** Online encyclopedias are convenient for a quick overview; (　　), academic essays require peer-reviewed sources.

**1** likewise　**2** consequently　**3** nonetheless　**4** for instance

***(11)*** Many commuters remain (　　) to the hidden brickwork in the subway vault until a guided architecture tour points it out.

**1** optional　**2** obedient　**3** obvious　**4** oblivious

***(12)*** The orchard switched to drip irrigation (　　) cutting water consumption during dry August weeks.

**1** in contrast to　**2** with a view to　**3** on behalf of　**4** regardless of

## 1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

**(13)** When assembling flat-pack furniture, tightening one screw completely before inserting the others can (　　) the frame out of alignment.

**1** preserve　**2** praise　**3** pull　**4** predict

**(14)** Local fishers welcomed the kelp restoration project, as sea urchins had (　　) wiped out the underwater forest.

**1** verbally　**2** virtually　**3** vaguely　**4** voluntarily

**(15)** The botanical garden prohibits picking wildflowers, lest rare native orchids (　　) from the hillside.

**1** disappear　**2** disappears　**3** disappeared　**4** to disappear

**(16)** In (　　) with fire-safety regulations, every corridor door in the dormitory closes automatically.

**1** collision　**2** comparison　**3** exchange　**4** accordance

**(17)** Having (　　) all afternoon cataloging old maps, the archivist locked the reading room at six.

**1** cost　**2** taken　**3** spent　**4** lasted

**2 A**

次の英文を読み、その文意にそって(18)から(20)までの（ ）に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選び、その番号のマーク欄をぬりつぶしなさい。

## *Why Airport Carpets Are Quieter Than Terminal Tiles*

Travelers rushing between airport gates with wheeled carry-on bags quickly feel the difference underfoot when polished stone hallways give way to low-pile carpet near seating areas. While stone and terrazzo tiles are easy to mop and let suitcase wheels glide effortlessly, many international terminals deliberately install wide stretches of patterned carpet around gates and quiet lounges.

Noise control is the primary reason. An airport concourse with glass walls and high metal ceilings acts like an echo chamber: announcements, rolling luggage, and hundreds of conversations bounce endlessly unless soft materials absorb sound waves. Stepping onto carpet immediately lowers ambient noise by several decibels, which reduces travel stress and makes boarding calls easier to hear. ( ***18*** ), softer flooring encourages passengers waiting for delayed flights to speak more quietly without even realizing it.

Designers also choose carpet patterns with surprising care. Subtle geometric weaves in blues, grays, or local landscape motifs hide coffee spills and wheel marks between nightly cleanings while making vast waiting halls feel more like calm living rooms. Heavy luggage carts do require slightly more force to push across carpet, however. ( ***19*** ), modern terminals lay smooth hard-stone "highways" down the center of main corridors and reserve carpet for gate seating zones.

Combining hard travel lanes with soft waiting islands shows how public architecture can ( ***20*** ).

***(18)***　**1** What is more　**2** On the contrary　**3** Otherwise　**4** Despite this

***(19)***　**1** Until recently　**2** By accident　**3** In contrast　**4** For this reason

***(20)***

**1** force all travelers to carry suitcases on their shoulders

**2** balance easy movement with acoustic comfort in crowded spaces

**3** replace all boarding announcements with flashing red lights

**4** keep airplanes from landing during rainy evenings

**2 B**

次の英文を読み、その文意にそって(21)から(23)までの（ ）に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選び、その番号のマーク欄をぬりつぶしなさい。

## *How Bakeries Reuse Unsold Bread Without Waste*

Artisan bakeries face a daily dilemma: customers expect shelves to offer a reasonable choice of loaves even at five in the afternoon, yet bread baked without preservatives loses its crisp crust by the next morning. Bake too little, and afternoon commuters leave disappointed; bake a safety margin, and unsold loaves pile up at closing time.

Discounting bread during the final hour helps, and food banks gladly collect part of the surplus. Even so, irregular weather—such as a sudden downpour at four o'clock—can leave dozens of baguettes untouched. Rather than throwing good grain away, traditional and modern bakers alike have developed tasty second lives for day-old bread. Sliced baguettes brushed with almond cream and baked twice become crisp almond bostock or rusks that stay fresh for weeks. ( ***21*** ), hearth loaves ground into fine crumbs can replace up to a quarter of the fresh flour in the next day's sourdough batch, adding deep toasted aroma.

Researchers studying food-fermentation cycles have taken reuse one step further. Some craft beverage makers partner with neighborhood bakeries to brew non-alcoholic malt drinks and kvass-style sodas from surplus crusts. ( ***22*** ), bakeries cut disposal costs while gaining a distinctive local drink to sell beside lunch sandwiches.

Turning yesterday's loaves into tomorrow's ingredients proves that ( ***23*** ).

***(21)***

**1** Otherwise　**2** However　**3** Likewise　**4** Instead

***(22)***

**1** Prior to baking　**2** Against their wishes

**3** Without any bread　**4** Through such partnerships

***(23)***

**1** culinary creativity can transform unavoidable surplus into valued products

**2** bakeries should close every day at eleven in the morning

**3** customers prefer stale bread over fresh morning loaves

**4** rainstorms never affect how many people visit neighborhood shops

**3 A**

次のEメールの内容に関して、(24)から(26)までの質問に対する答えとして最も適切なもの、または文を完成させるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

From: Mr. Nagase, Art Club Advisor
To: Ceramic Section Members
Subject: Packing glazed works for Friday's exhibition van

Hello ceramic members,
The courier van for the Prefectural High School Art Exhibition will arrive at our loading bay at 8:15 a.m. this Friday. Because thirty fragile bowls, vases, and teapots must travel forty kilometers over mountain roads, we will pack every piece together after school on Thursday—do not pack your work alone during lunch break.

Each piece must follow the "double-box" rule: wrap your work in three layers of bubble wrap, place it inside a small inner carton cushioned with crumpled newspaper, and then set that inner carton inside a larger outer crate with five centimeters of padding on all sides. Never pack two ceramic pieces inside the same inner carton without a thick cardboard divider, even if they belong to a matching tea set; vibration on curves makes unseparated glazes chip against each other.

Write your school code and catalog number on the OUTSIDE of both cartons with a black marker, and slip your printed title card into the clear pouch on top of the outer crate.

See you Thursday at 3:50 p.m.,
T. Nagase

## 3A　Guidelines for the Inter-High Pottery Packing Day　設問 (24)〜(26)

***(24)*** Why must students NOT place two ceramic pieces together in an inner carton without a thick divider?

**1** Judges disqualify tea sets that arrive in the same van.

**2** Road vibrations can cause the glazed surfaces to hit each other and chip.

**3** Bubble wrap melts when two bowls sit side by side.

**4** Newspaper ink changes the color of fired clay.

***(25)*** When should members pack their ceramic works?

**1** Together after school on Thursday.

**2** Individually during Thursday's lunch break.

**3** On Friday afternoon after the van leaves.

**4** At home on Wednesday night.

***(26)*** Where should the printed title card be placed?

**1** Taped directly onto the bottom of the vase.

**2** Folded inside crumpled newspaper.

**3** In the clear pouch on top of the outer crate.

**4** Handed to the bus driver next Monday.

**3 B**

次の英文の内容に関して、(27)から(31)までの質問に対する答えとして最も適切なもの、または文を完成させるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

## *Why Ancient Roman Sea Concrete Lasted Millennia*

Modern steel-reinforced concrete is the backbone of bridges, ports, and high-rises around the world. Strong as it is on land, ordinary Portland cement concrete struggles in saltwater: within fifty to eighty years, seawater seeps through microscopic pores, rusts the internal steel bars, and causes the surrounding stone to crack and flake. Walk along Italian harbors built two thousand years ago, however, and you can still stand on unreinforced Roman concrete breakwaters that have endured pounding Mediterranean waves since antiquity.

For centuries, historians knew from ancient texts that Roman builders mixed volcanic ash from the Bay of Naples with lime and seawater, then packed the mortar around chunks of volcanic rock. Yet only recently did mineralogists using high-energy X-ray beams uncover the chemical secret inside surviving harbor cores. Where modern engineers strive to crush and blend lime until no lumps remain, Roman mortar contained tiny white mineral flecks once dismissed as sloppy mixing.

Far from being mistakes, those reactive lime flecks give the concrete a remarkable self-healing ability. Whenever wave stress opens a hairline crack, seawater trickles in, dissolves calcium from the lime flecks, and reacts with silica-rich volcanic ash to grow interlocking crystal plates right across the gap. Instead of widening into a structural failure, small fractures seal themselves and bind the rock tighter over decades.

Simply copying Roman recipes word for word will not suit every twenty-first-century project; Roman harbor concrete cured slowly and lacked the steel needed for slender highway spans. Even so, materials scientists are already adapting lime-and-volcanic-ash chemistry to design lower-carbon marine concretes that need fewer repairs.

Studying ancient harbors reminds engineers that durability sometimes comes from working with water's chemistry rather than fighting to keep every drop out.

## 3B　Why Ancient Roman Sea Concrete Lasted Millennia　設問 (27)〜(31)

***(27)*** Why does modern steel-reinforced concrete often deteriorate within decades in saltwater?

**1** Fish eat Portland cement for minerals.

**2** Modern builders forget to add sand to their cement.

**3** Ocean waves are ten times stronger today than in antiquity.

**4** Seawater penetrates tiny pores and corrodes the internal steel bars, cracking the concrete.

***(28)*** How had researchers previously misinterpreted the tiny white lime flecks in Roman mortar?

**1** As decorative pearls placed for emperors.

**2** As signs of careless, incomplete mixing.

**3** As fossilized sea salt from dried fish.

**4** As fragments of rusted iron tools.

***(29)*** What happens when seawater enters a hairline crack in Roman harbor concrete?

**1** The entire breakwater dissolves within a week.

**2** Air bubbles push the volcanic rocks apart.

**3** Dissolved calcium reacts with volcanic ash to grow crystals that seal the crack.

**4** The concrete turns soft like wet clay.

***(30)*** Why can't twenty-first-century engineers use ancient Roman concrete unchanged for every structure?

**1** Volcanic ash no longer exists anywhere on Earth.

**2** It cures slowly and lacks the steel reinforcement required for slender spans like highway bridges.

**3** International maritime law bans lime near harbors.

**4** It melts whenever temperatures drop below twenty degrees.

***(31)*** How are contemporary materials scientists making use of these findings?

**1** By developing lower-carbon, longer-lasting marine concretes inspired by lime-and-ash reactions.

**2** By tearing down historic Italian harbors.

**3** By replacing all coastal bridges with wooden ferries.

**4** By painting ordinary steel bars bright white.